



Figure 6: Test results

Advantages of TestLink

- Open source
- Quick installation
- Being Web-based, it can be accessed by the whole company
- Consolidated reports can be generated and sent for review
- Email notifications on assignment of test cases
- Import or export of test reports, test plans and requirements (only XML is supported)
- Requirement can be matched with test cases
- Track progress on a daily basis
- Receive event logs by email

Limitations and disadvantages of TestLink

- Many features make this tool a little complicated.
- At least one person who has very good knowledge of how to set up servers and databases is needed to maintain and install this tool.

then click on the *Create* platform. Use Linux as the platform name and save; do the same for Windows XP platform.

Now that we have all the required data, platforms and the test cases to be executed, we will assign them to the user.

Add platforms to be used, go to *Desktop*→*Test Plan Contents*→*Add/Remove platforms* and save.

Go to *Desktop*→*Test Plan Contents*→*Add/Remove Test Cases* and then click on the desired test cases to be added. Select the platform and the test cases as per requirement. As given in Figure 3, we are selecting two test cases for Linux, two for Windows, and two are to be repeated on both. Now click on *Add selected*; the selected test cases will be highlighted in yellow. You can directly assign the user in this page also, but it is recommended that you use the next step

to assign the test cases to the respective users.

Assigning users

The users are now to be assigned to the test cases. To assign a user, go to *Desktop*→*Test Plan Contents*→*Assign Test Case Execution* and select the users. As we have only two users—*admin* and *user1* (the user we created)—we will assign four test cases to *user1* and four to *admin*, as can be seen in Figure 4. After assigning a user, click on 'Save'. These assignments can also be notified to the users through email, but for that to work properly SMTP parameters should be defined in *custom_config.inc.php*.

Generating a test report

Next, go to *Test Reports*, click on *General Test Plan Metrics*, and then on *Overall Build Status*. This will show the details of build number and the total number of test cases to be executed. We have six test cases but two are to be executed twice, so the total count will be four test cases to be executed on Linux and four on Windows; the total number is calculated as eight, as shown in Figure 5.

Logout from admin and login with 'user1' credentials; you will see fewer menus on the home page for the role of 'senior tester'. Go to *Test Execution* and select the platform as Linux. You will see two test cases. Mark one test case as 'passed' and the other as 'failed'. Change the platform to Windows XP, and again mark one test case as 'passed' and the other as 'blocked', as shown in Figure 6.

After completing the above steps, go to *Test Reports* and click on *General Test Plan Metrics*. You can see the status as '4 not run (assigned to admin), 2 passed, 1 failed and 1 blocked'. The results as per platform can also be seen.

Overall, TestLink can be a great addition to the software testing process and simplifies the management of various critical functions involved in completing the test cycle. The 'Custom fields' option adds the flexibility to tune this software to your requirements. **END** 

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